

100 Days of Linux - Day 047

Title: Interactive Process Monitoring with htop

Today's Goal

Learn how to install (if needed), navigate, search, and manage processes using the **htop** command.

Why This Matters

htop provides a colorful, interactive view of system resources, making it easier to monitor applications and troubleshoot performance problems.

Command of the Day: htop

Install (Ubuntu/WSL):

```
sudo apt update  
sudo apt install htop
```

Run:

```
htop
```

Useful Keys:

```
F3 = Search  
F4 = Filter  
F5 = Tree View  
F6 = Sort By  
F9 = Kill Process  
F10 = Quit
```

Important Columns:

```
PID, USER, CPU%, MEM%, TIME+, Command
```

Beginner Lesson

htop is similar to top but is easier to read and navigate. You can scroll through processes, search by name, switch sorting options, and manage processes from one screen.

Practice Questions

1. Install htop if it is not already installed, then launch it.
2. Search for your shell process (bash or zsh) using the search feature.
3. Switch to Tree View and observe parent and child processes.
4. Sort processes by memory usage, identify one high-memory process, then exit htop.
5. Display your current working directory after completing today's tasks.

Hints

Function keys work while htop is running. If your keyboard requires it, press Fn together with the function key.

Mini Challenge

Open another terminal and run 'sleep 300'. Use htop to locate the

sleep process, note its PID, then stop it using Ctrl+C from the other terminal.

Common Mistakes

Trying to use htop before installing it. On many WSL installations it is not installed by default.

Did You Know?

htop can display processes as a tree, making it much easier to understand how applications start child processes.

Pro Tip

If htop is unavailable on a server, you can always fall back to top or ps.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: `sudo apt update && sudo apt install htop && htop`

Q2: Press F3 and search for bash or zsh

Q3: Press F5

Q4: Press F6, choose MEM%, then F10 to quit

Q5: `pwd`

Homework

Compare top and htop. Write down three advantages of htop after using both tools.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn the kill command to safely stop running processes using their Process ID (PID).